Bihar a 500-bedded facility was planned to be up and running in less than two weeks.[34]

To further explain the volatility of the situation on ground and how the entire government machinery—the Centre and states—worked in tandem with each other, to usher in life-saving solutions, it is important to note Iqbal Chahal, MCGM Commissioner's experience. On the intervening night of 17 April, when the city of Mumbai was logging over 8,000 new coronavirus cases per day, oxygen supplies in six hospitals in the city was on the brink of running out. Maharashtra's total installed oxygen capacity was about 1,200 metric tonnes, which included oxygen for industrial, COVID-19 and non-COVID-19 use. By the first week of April, the state had begun to consume 90 per cent of its available oxygen. That is when the state COVID-19 task force projected that within a week, oxygen consumption would increase to over 1,700 metric tonnes and arrangements to amplify supply would have to be made immediately. They requested the central government to allocate about 500 metric tonnes, which was approved. The oxygen was planned to be transported from Haldia in West Bengal to Mumbai, with a turnaround time of eight days. In the forthcoming days, Chahal noted,

> In the midst of these talks, on the intervening night of April 16-17, I was informed around midnight that six hospitals were running out of oxygen. There were 168 patients there… So, between 1 am and 5 am, we deployed 150 ambulances and brought these patients to our jumbo COVID centres. Fortunately, we had 3,600 empty beds, of which 850 were oxygenated beds. I was so relieved that no lives were lost. After the operation, I couldn't sleep at all, and around 7 am I sent messages to top functionaries of the Government of India, including the Cabinet Secretary, Home Secretary, Health Secretary… I sent another set of messages to top eight leaders of Maharashtra, starting with the honourable CM. I said, this is not the end of the problem and this may happen again. Within 15–20 seconds, I had an incoming call coming from the Cabinet Secretary, Rajiv Gauba. He told me, tell me what you want… I said we have to import oxygen into the state. I told him that we can't manufacture oxygen at such short notice and that the turnaround time for oxygen coming from Haldia was around eight days… I worked under Gauba sir when I was joint secretary in the Ministry of Home